

✓ **1. Tell me about yourself.**

Answer (fresher version):

I recently completed my post-graduation in [Your Degree] with a strong interest in finance and data analysis. During my academic journey, I developed skills in Excel, SQL, and data handling. I am particularly interested in fixed income markets and reference data management. I am looking for an opportunity at S&P Global where I can contribute to high-quality financial data operations while continuously learning from industry experts.

✓ **2. Why do you want to join S&P Global?**

S&P Global is a globally respected organization known for high-quality financial data and analytics. I am particularly interested in the Reference Data team because it plays a critical role in supporting risk management and valuation. As a fresher, I see this as an excellent opportunity to learn from industry experts while contributing to data quality and operational excellence.

✓ **3. Why this role?**

This role perfectly matches my interest in finance and data analysis. It combines fixed income knowledge, data quality, and analytical work. I enjoy working with structured data and ensuring accuracy, which are key aspects of this role.

✓ **4. What are your strengths?**

My key strengths are attention to detail, analytical thinking, and willingness to learn. I am comfortable working with large datasets in Excel and SQL and I always focus on maintaining data accuracy and quality.

✓ **5. What is your weakness?**

As a fresher, I am still building deeper domain expertise in fixed income markets, but I am actively improving through continuous learning and market tracking.

✓ **6. Are you comfortable working in shifts/global teams?**

Yes, I am comfortable working in global team environments and flexible shifts. I understand the importance of supporting international markets.

✓ **7. Where do you see yourself in 5 years?**

In five years, I see myself as a domain expert in reference data and fixed income markets, contributing to process improvements and taking on greater responsibilities within S&P Global.

✓ **10. Why should we hire you?**

I bring strong attention to detail, basic finance knowledge, and data handling skills. I am eager to learn and contribute to maintaining high-quality reference data at S&P Global.

 SECTION B — Finance & Bond Basics (VERY IMPORTANT)

✓ **8. What is a bond?**

A bond is a fixed income instrument where an investor lends money to an issuer in exchange for periodic interest payments and repayment of principal at maturity.

✓ **9. What is coupon rate?**

Coupon rate is the annual interest rate paid by the bond issuer on the bond's face value.

✓ **10. Difference between coupon rate and yield?**

Coupon rate is the fixed interest paid on face value, while yield represents the actual return earned by the investor based on the market price of the bond.

✓ **11. What is Yield to Maturity (YTM)?**

Yield to Maturity is the total expected return on a bond if held until maturity, considering coupon payments and capital gain or loss.

✓ **12. What happens to bond prices when interest rates rise?**

★ VERY COMMON

Bond prices fall when interest rates rise because newly issued bonds offer higher yields, making existing bonds less attractive.

✓ **13. What is face value?**

Face value is the principal amount of the bond that is repaid to the investor at maturity.

✓ **14. What is ISIN?**

ISIN (International Securities Identification Number) is a unique 12-character code used to identify financial securities globally.

✓ **15. Types of bonds you know?**

Government bonds, corporate bonds, zero-coupon bonds, floating rate bonds, and convertible bonds.

✓ **16. What is credit rating?**

Credit rating indicates the creditworthiness of a bond issuer and the likelihood of default.

✓ **17. What is accrued interest?**

Accrued interest is the interest accumulated on a bond since the last coupon payment date.

16. Relationship between interest rates and bond prices?

★ VERY IMPORTANT

Bond prices and interest rates have an inverse relationship. When interest rates rise, bond prices fall and vice versa.

32. How do you handle data discrepancies?

Validate → cross-check → correct → document → perform RCA.

📁 **SECTION C — Reference Data (CORE OF ROLE)**

✓ **18. What is reference data?**

★ VERY IMPORTANT

Reference data is static or slowly changing data used to identify financial instruments and entities, such as ISIN, issuer name, coupon rate, and maturity date.

✓ **19. Why is reference data important?**

Reference data ensures accurate trading, valuation, risk management, and regulatory reporting across financial systems.

✓ **20. Give examples of bond reference data fields.**

ISIN, issuer name, coupon rate, maturity date, currency, credit rating, and issue date.

✓ **21. What is data quality?**

Data quality refers to the accuracy, completeness, consistency, and reliability of data used for business decisions.

✓ **22. How will you ensure data accuracy?**

I would perform validation checks, cross-verify with trusted sources, run consistency checks, and perform root cause analysis for any discrepancies.

✓ **23. What is root cause analysis?**

Root cause analysis is the process of identifying the underlying reason for a data issue to prevent it from recurring.

✓ **24. How would you handle data inconsistency?**

I would first validate the discrepancy, compare with authoritative sources, correct the data if required, document the issue, and perform root cause analysis.

 SECTION D — SQL (Basic but Expected)

✓ **25. What is SQL?**

SQL is a language used to query, manage, and manipulate data in relational databases.

✓ **26. Difference between WHERE and HAVING?**

WHERE filters rows before aggregation, while HAVING filters aggregated results after GROUP BY.

✓ **27. Write SQL to count bonds per issuer.**

```
SELECT issuer_name, COUNT(*) AS bond_count
FROM bonds
GROUP BY issuer_name;
```

✓ **28. What is JOIN?**

JOIN is used to combine rows from two or more tables based on a related column.

✓ **29. Types of joins?**

INNER JOIN, LEFT JOIN, RIGHT JOIN, FULL OUTER JOIN.

 SECTION E — Excel (They Often Ask)

✓ **30. What is VLOOKUP?**

VLOOKUP is used to search for a value in the first column of a table and return a corresponding value from another column.

✓ **31. What is a Pivot Table?**

A pivot table is used to summarize and analyze large datasets by grouping and aggregating data.

✓ **32. How do you handle large data in Excel?**

By using filters, pivot tables, proper formulas, removing duplicates, and ensuring structured formatting.

 SECTION F — Situational / Operations

✓ **33. How do you handle tight deadlines?**

I prioritize tasks based on urgency and impact, maintain accuracy while working efficiently, and communicate proactively if any risks arise.

✓ **34. How will you handle client escalation?**

I would listen carefully, verify the issue, provide accurate resolution, and ensure timely communication while maintaining professionalism.

✓ **35. Are you comfortable with repetitive work?**

⚠ They test attitude here.

Best answer:

Yes. I understand that consistency and accuracy are critical in reference data operations. I focus on maintaining quality and also look for opportunities to improve processes.
